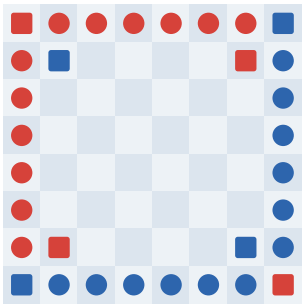
Lipfty - How to play

Lipfty 17 gameplay candidate (v13.0.4 revival). Research release v17.0.9. Shared colours: neither player owns Red or Blue.

1. Setup

Play on the central 6 x 6 of an 8 x 8 board. Four shaped Opening Four pieces are already pinned to the four inner corners: two Red and two Blue, with matching colours on opposite diagonals. They count towards winning patterns from the beginning, cannot Move or Jump, and cannot be jumped over. Their setup is not counted as a board action.

Place 24 ordinary round reserve pieces (12 of each colour) on the non-corner outer edge spaces. Place four shaped Final Four pieces (two of each colour) at the four outer physical corners. These wait until the endgame.



4 pinned opening anchors

24 ordinary reserves

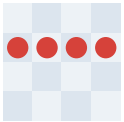
4 outer Final Four specials

Played after ordinary reserves

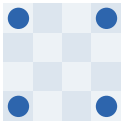
2. How to win

Complete four of either shared colour in a horizontal, vertical or diagonal straight line (Learning, Easy and Standard). Standard also allows all four corners of any axis-aligned tight or spaced square. The player completing the winning pattern wins, regardless of the pieces' colour.

Check for a win after each Place, Move, Jump and compulsory placement. A win cancels all outstanding placements immediately.



Line: all versions



Square: Standard

3. Normal turns

The opponent hands you an ordinary reserve piece, choosing which colour you must use. If only one colour remains, it is selected automatically. You may Place it on any empty inner square. In Easy and Standard you may instead Move an unpinned board piece of that colour by one adjacent square, or Jump it over one adjacent opposite-colour unpinned piece into an empty square immediately beyond. Moves and Jumps may be horizontal, vertical or diagonal. Jumps remove the jumped piece temporarily for redeployment. One jump only.

The exact piece previously moved or jumped is protected against the opponent's next Move or Jump. All opening and Final Four pieces are permanently pinned. Learning is Place only.

4. Accept or Take

After the first ordinary placement, the opponent chooses Accept (continue as the next player) or Take position (make the initial placer continue). The piece stays on the board and playing colours remain shared.

5. After a Move

If the Move did not win, the opponent chooses another ordinary reserve piece of an available colour and places it, then the mover places the exact originally handed piece. The held piece is not available to the responder. The opponent then takes a normal turn. A Move requires at least one other ordinary reserve piece besides the held piece.

Then TWO placements

Opponent first; mover second

Hold the selected reserve until its placement.

6. After a Jump

If the Jump did not win, the jumper holds the exact handed piece and the exact jumped piece is removed. The opponent chooses either of these two pieces and places it, then the jumper places the other. The opponent then takes a normal turn. Neither piece can be substituted. Any immediate win ends the sequence.

This uses the historical v13.0.4 app rule: the opponent chooses between the two pieces. The older photographed printout differs on this point and is preserved as a research reference.

Then TWO placements

Opponent first; mover second

Jumped Blue is redeployed.

7. Ordinary-reserve cutoff and Final Four

As soon as one ordinary reserve colour runs out, normal turns become Place only, with any compulsory sequence already begun completed first. When all 24 ordinary pieces have been used, the Final Four phase starts: on each turn, the current player chooses one outer corner special and places it on any empty inner square. The four specials are permanently pinned. No Move or Jump occurs in Final Four. If all four are placed without a win, the game is a draw.

8. Matches and options

Choose Single game, Best of 3 or Best of 5. A game win awards one point, and a draw earns none; the same numbered game is replayed after a draw. Starters alternate between games, even after a draw. Match scores appear separately from the physical corner pieces, which now belong to gameplay.

Optional clock, Undo, highlights, colour choice, statistics and offline PWA behaviour are retained. A clock expiry loses the game. Undo restores the game and match position where possible.

Play: https://blarm1959.github.io/Lipfty-App/